ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	24th Commission Meeting
DATE:	29 April 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	**Invitation to "*Professional Development Programme on Unmasking Hidden Wealth: Strengthening Investigations into Illicit Enrichment*" – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the invitation received from the Independent Commission Against Corruption (ICAC), Hong Kong SAR, China, for the "**Professional Development Programme on Unmasking Hidden Wealth: Strengthening Investigations into Illicit Enrichment**". The programme is co-organised by the Hong Kong International Academy Against Corruption (HKIAAC) and the GlobE Network under the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC).* *The programme is scheduled to be held from 07-16 September 2026 in Hong Kong SAR, China, with an additional four-day study tour to the Chinese Mainland. It was noted that the programme will comprise expert-led lectures, practical case studies, institutional exchanges, and cross-jurisdictional dialogue, with a focus on strengthening investigative competencies in illicit enrichment. While the course fees will be borne by ICAC, participants will be required to meet expenses related to travel, meals, and accommodation. Accommodation options include hotel arrangements ranging from USD 80-170 per night or ICAC's residential facility at no cost, with transport to the venue provided. The study tour component is estimated to incur an additional cost of approximately USD 700. The deadline for submitting the nomination is on or before 31 May 2026. It was further noted that, as Bhutan is not currently a member of the GlobE Network, endorsement from UNODC would be required to facilitate the ACC's participation.* *Recalling past capacity development programmes, including the Leadership and Executive Development (LED) Programme, Postgraduate Certificate Course in Corruption Studies, and Senior Executive Certificate in*	**Decided to decline the invitation and directed the HRS to undertake a comprehensive stocktaking of training programmes offered by the HKIAAC, including a record of those previously regretted. Based on this, HRS to conduct an analysis to distinguish programmes that are critical and not readily available elsewhere, and those that can be availed through alternative platforms. This is expected to enable submission of clear and reasoned proposal to the MoFAET, substantiating that while participation in most programmes has been judiciously declined in the past, the specific programme is indispensable to the ACC's mandate and operational effectiveness.**

	Institutional Integrity Management, the Commission acknowledged their substantive contribution to professional capacity enhancement. However, it was also noted that such programmes were subsequently discontinued following the guidance of the MoFAET, which adopts a case-by-case clearance approach, with a preference for international and multilateral programmes and a general discouragement of those coordinated through local counterparts.	
2	**Proposal for consolidation of legal documents and advisories – LD** *LD sought the Commission's endorsement to coordinate a drafting workshop aimed at consolidating and finalising key legal documents and advisories in line with the performance targets set for FY 2025-2026. These include:* *i) Gift Rules,* *ii) Witness Protection Guideline, and* *iii) Guideline on Children in Conflict with the Law (Corruption).* *Further, drawing from the feedback received from the Commission and Management during the recent training on "**Elementisation of Offences**", the LD proposed to develop:* *i) offence-wise elements-to-evidence matrix, and* *ii) guideline on the framing of probable charges and chargesheets.* *Considering the magnitude and technical nature of the assignment, LD proposed to engage all eight officials within the Division for a duration of approx. nine (09) days. It was further proposed that the workshop be conducted outside Thimphu, preferably in Bumthang, with a view to ensuring dedicated focus and optimising the participation of LO stationed at BRO.* *While acknowledging the importance of the proposed workshop in strengthening legal instruments and fulfilling the performance targets, the Commission underscored the need to ensure that the exercise is carried out in the most cost-efficient manner. Recalling the MoF's directive to minimise such modalities of delivery except in exceptional circumstances, the Commission emphasised the need for clearly defined, tangible, and realistic deliverables to justify the proposal.* *Furthermore, the Commission deliberated on the operational implications of engaging all eight officials simultaneously, particularly in light of the Division's continued requirement for legal advice in the cases and other pressing legal issues.*	**Endorsed the proposal with following specific directives:** - **LD to clearly define and prioritise tangible deliverables that are critical for the current FY, with non-priority components deferred to the subsequent FY.** - **LD to coordinate the workshop with a limited number of key officials (2-3), based on their roles under specific deliverables identified.** - **PPD to ensure that such activities are appropriately reflected and integrated into future performance plans.**

3	**Present brief on the upcoming Regional Seminar of Anti-Corruption Initiative for Asia and the Pacific – PPD** *PPD apprised the Commission on the background, structure, and strategic relevance of the Anti-Corruption Initiative for Asia and the Pacific (ACI), along with the upcoming Regional Seminar and related engagements in Tashkent, Uzbekistan, scheduled from 12-14 May 2026. In doing so, PPD outlined the key sessions of the Seminar, which will focus on areas such as conflict-of-interest management, integrity risk management, whistleblower protection systems, incentives for corporate compliance, and broader business integrity frameworks. PPD further apprised the Commission of the invitation received from the OECD to share Bhutan's experience on business integrity incentives and associated programmes as part of the Business Integrity Regional Snapshot (BIRS) initiative.* *In addition, PPD presented the proposed side-line meetings with key counterpart agencies and development partners, including the Anti-Corruption Agency of Uzbekistan, OECD, Corrupt Practices Investigation Bureau of Singapore, Asian Development Bank, and the National Anti-Corruption Commission of Thailand. These engagements are expected to focus on areas such as compliance systems, business integrity initiatives, international cooperation, and institutional partnerships.* *The Commission recognised the strategic value of participating in such events, both in strengthening institutional capacity and in advancing Bhutan's role in regional and international anti-corruption cooperation. With regard to the OECD's invitation, the Commission noted that Bhutan's business integrity initiative is still at a pilot stage. Notwithstanding this, the Commission emphasised that, in future engagements, officials representing the ACC should make more deliberate use of such platforms to present Bhutan's perspectives, including sharing considered suggestions and insights, rather than confining participation to capacity building alone.*	**Noted and directed to decline the invitation to share Bhutan's experience on business integrity.**
	Follow up to the launch of the CoRE Network of Bhutan – DARe & PPD *PPD and DARe, following the successful launch of the CoRE Network earlier in the day, sought the Commission's endorsement on the designation of the Secretariat to the Network, as well as the proposed timeline and composition of officials for a workshop among CoRE Network members. The workshop aims to develop following key documents:* *i) Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA),* *ii) Guideline for Data Classification, and*	**Endorsed the proposal with following specific directives:** - **PPD and SS to assume the Secretariat function of the CoRE Network, with PPD as the lead, and ensure that the Network operates in a coordinated, objective, and sustainable manner.**

	iii) SOP for Data Sharing among member agencies. *In addition to the nominated officials to the CoRE Network Group, one Legal Officer from each partner agency viz. DLO, DRC, RBP, RMA, and ACC was proposed for inclusion in the workshop to ensure legal consistency and coherence across the proposed documents.* *From the ACC, in view of the technical nature of the deliverables and its role as Secretariat to the Network, PPD and DARe proposed the inclusion of selected officials from the LD and relevant Departments/Divisions (if any) to support the development of these documents, particularly drawing on the LD's prior work on the Standards for Information Classification and Handling.* *Further, to ensure dedicated focus and to foster collegiality among CoRE Network members for sustained collaboration, the workshop was proposed to be conducted outside Thimphu for a week (from 20-26 May 2026). It was also proposed to align the workshop timing with the LD's scheduled outstation engagement to optimise the availability of legal expertise.* *The Commission emphasised the need to ensure that the Secretariat function is undertaken with utmost objectivity, with due consideration to the institutionalization and long-term sustainability of the Network.*	- **workshop to also optimize development of tangible activities for the operationalisation of the CoRE Network. Where necessary, any requirements relating to budget and resources to be submitted for approval to the Governing Committee in its upcoming meeting.**
4	**Debrief on the 5th Finance Committee – SS & PPD** *Pursuant to the decision of the 23rd Commission Meeting held on 22 April 2026, SS consulted the NHDCL to obtain an estimate for the construction of the proposed housing colony at Gangchey. In response, NHDCL informed that, based on preliminary design and topographical survey considerations, the overall construction cost is estimated at approx. Nu. 485 million, with an additional Nu. 3-4 million required for design and drawings. In comparison, a private architectural firm, Mandala Architect, indicated an estimated cost of approx. Nu. 3.8 million (excluding GST) for the design and drawing component. The design and drawing work is expected to take about 3-5 months.* *Based on these inputs, SS and PPD presented two options to the Finance Committee for the utilisation of the remaining budget of Nu. 1.173 million, saved from the GPU procurement (Nu. 3.845 million expected expenditures against the total allocated budget of Nu. 5.000 million):* *i) to utilise the available budget towards the design and drawing component, with the balance requirement to be met from the next FY; **or***	**Endorsed the decision of the Finance Committee.**

	ii) *to allocate a portion of the budget towards engaging consultancy services for the development of ToR for the design and drawing or alternatively leverage existing in-house capacity of Jangchu and Yejay's experience in developing the ToR and utilise the budget saving for the procurement of laptops, where 17 have reached end-of-life and several others require critical repairs.* *While the Finance Committee decided in favour of the second option, particularly leveraging in-house capacity, SS and PPD sought the Commission's guidance on the proposed approach.*	

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**